

Instagram Basic Display API

Setup Guide for Option A

Everything you need to enable an auto-syncing Instagram feed on your site. Once steps 1–6 are done and your .env values are in place, the implementation work is on me.

1. Meta Developer Account (free)
2. Create a Meta App
3. Add the Instagram Basic Display product
4. Configure OAuth redirect URIs
5. Add yourself as an Instagram Tester
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1. Meta Developer Account (free)

Go to <https://developers.facebook.com> → click **Get Started** → log in with your personal Facebook account (or create one). Accept the developer terms.

What to send me: nothing yet — just confirm you're past this step.

Important: this Facebook account doesn't need to be linked to anything — it's just the "owner" of the app you're about to create. Any FB account works.

2. Create a Meta App

- 1 Inside the developer dashboard, click **My Apps** → **Create App**
- 2 Use case: **Other**
- 3 App type: **Consumer**
- 4 App name: anything like *Cristina Bio* (internal — fans never see it)
- 5 Contact email: yours
- 6 Click **Create App**

3. Add the Instagram Basic Display product

- 1 From your new app's dashboard, scroll to **Add products to your app**
- 2 Find **Instagram Basic Display** → click **Set up**

- 3 Inside Instagram Basic Display, click **Create New App** (sets up an Instagram App alongside your Meta App)
- 4 Click **Save Changes**

4. Configure OAuth redirect URIs

These are the URLs Instagram sends users back to after authorizing. Inside **Instagram Basic Display** → **Basic Display**:

Valid OAuth Redirect URIs:

`http://localhost:5000/api/instagram/oauth/callback`
`https://your-real-domain.com/api/instagram/oauth/callback` (add when you deploy)

Deauthorize Callback URL:

`http://localhost:5000/api/instagram/oauth/deauthorize`

Data Deletion Request URL:

`http://localhost:5000/api/instagram/oauth/data-deletion`

I'll implement the deauthorize + data-deletion endpoints on the backend — they're required by Meta but rarely actually called.

5. Add yourself as an Instagram Tester

Because the app starts in **Development Mode**, only people explicitly added as "Instagram Testers" can connect their Instagram. This is fine for now — when you go live to real fans, you flip the app to **Live Mode** (one form, ~5-minute review by Meta).

- 1 Instagram Basic Display → **User Token Generator** → click **Add or Remove Instagram Testers**
- 2 Enter your Instagram username: `cristinadd2m`
- 3 Open Instagram on your phone → **Settings** → **Apps and Websites** → **Tester Invites** → **Accept**

6. Collect the three values I need

Where to find	What to copy
Instagram Basic Display → Basic Display → Instagram App ID	INSTAGRAM_APP_ID
Instagram Basic Display → Basic Display → Instagram App Secret (click "Show")	INSTAGRAM_APP_SECRET
Your Instagram username	cristinadd2m (already have)

Treat the App Secret like a password — don't paste it in chat. Drop it into `server/.env` as:

```
INSTAGRAM_APP_ID=123456789012345
INSTAGRAM_APP_SECRET=abc123def456ghi789jkl012mno345pqr
INSTAGRAM_REDIRECT_URI=http://localhost:5000/api/instagram/oauth/callback
```

7. (Optional) Privacy Policy URL

Meta requires a Privacy Policy URL on the app's Basic Settings page when you go Live. For development you can paste a placeholder. For production:

- Use a free generator: <https://www.termsfeed.com/privacy-policy-generator/>
- Or ask the dev to write a minimal one tailored to this platform

8. What the dev will build once those env vars are in place

- **"Connect Instagram"** button in Bio Builder → Instagram Posts card
- **Backend OAuth flow:**
 - GET `/api/instagram/oauth/start` → redirects to Instagram authorize URL
 - GET `/api/instagram/oauth/callback` → exchanges code → stores long-lived 60-day token on the Creator row
 - GET `/api/instagram/oauth/deauthorize` + data-deletion stubs (required by Meta)
- **Schema additions** (auto-migrated by Sequelize):
 - `Creator.instagramAccessToken`
 - `Creator.instagramTokenExpiry`
 - `Creator.instagramUserId`
 - `Creator.instagramUsername`
- **Auto-fetch on** GET `/api/instagram/:slug` — uses the stored token, fetches the latest 25 media items, caches for 1 hour, returns real CDN URLs (no more 403s).
- **Token refresh job** — when the cached token is <7 days from expiry, refresh in the background (Instagram's refresh endpoint, no re-auth required).

After it's all wired up:

- You click **Connect Instagram** once.

- Authorize in Instagram's flow.
- Your 25 latest posts appear in the 3x3 grid automatically.
- Posting a new IG post → it shows up on your site within an hour (cache TTL).

9. Timeline summary

Step	Who	Time
Steps 1-6 above	You	~15 min
Build backend + UI	Dev	~2 hours
Test together	Both	10 min
Switch app Dev → Live mode (one button + Meta's automated review)	You	~5 min + 1-3 days Meta review

Start whenever you're ready. Once steps 1-6 are done and the env vars are in server / .env, ping the dev and the wiring goes in.